Expense Tracker - UI/UX Case Study

Project Overview

The Expense Tracker app is a website designed to help users manage their finances efficiently by tracking income, expenses, and savings in real-time.

My goal for this project was to create a minimal, intuitive, and visually engaging interface that simplifies personal finance management for users of all ages

I was the sole designer on this project, responsible for everything — user research, persona development, information architecture, wireframing, and final UI design

Problem Statement

Many people find it challenging to track and analyze their spending habits. Existing expense tracker apps often suffer from:

- Overwhelming interfaces
- Poor categorization of expenses
- Limited visualization of financial data
- Lack of motivation to consistently log expenses

Objective:

Design an app that encourages regular use, provides clear insights into spending patterns, and makes financial tracking simple and rewarding.

User persona

Name: Mehara

First-job professionals struggling to manage salary and savings for the first time

Age: 21

Occupation: Software Engineer

Location: Hyderabad

Income: 30000

Pain points

- Finds finance apps too complicated and overwhelming
- Doesn't understand charts or financial terms
- Often spends impulsively without realizing
- Forgets to track expenses regularly

Motivations

- Wants financial independence
- Wants to plan for future goals
- Inspired by others who are saving money

Goals

- Save money
- Avoid overspending
- Track money habits

Behavior

- Prefers simple and clean interfaces
- Uses mobile apps daily
- Has short attention span for complex dashboards
- Likely to drop apps that feel time-consuming

Needs

- A simple dashboard showing balance and spending
- clear insights
- Visual representation of spendings

Design Goals

- Minimal & Clean Layout for quick reading
- Instant Overview Cards for total income, total expense, and balance
- Recent Transactions List for easy tracking
- Expense Summary Chart for visual understanding
- One-click access to Add Transaction
- Set up target goals to encourage saving
- Monthly report of spendings

UI Decisions

- Summary Cards:

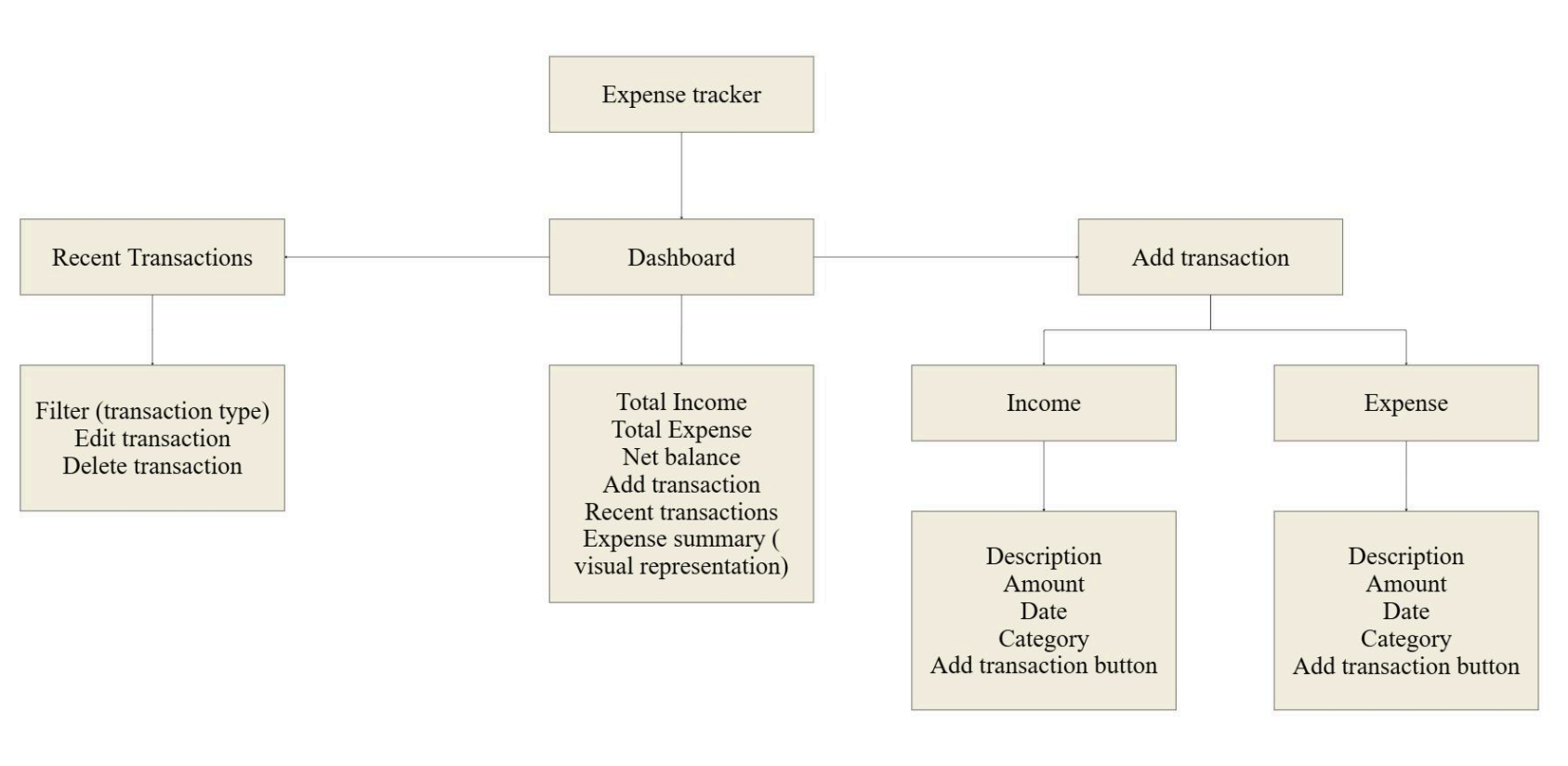
Green for income

Red for expenses

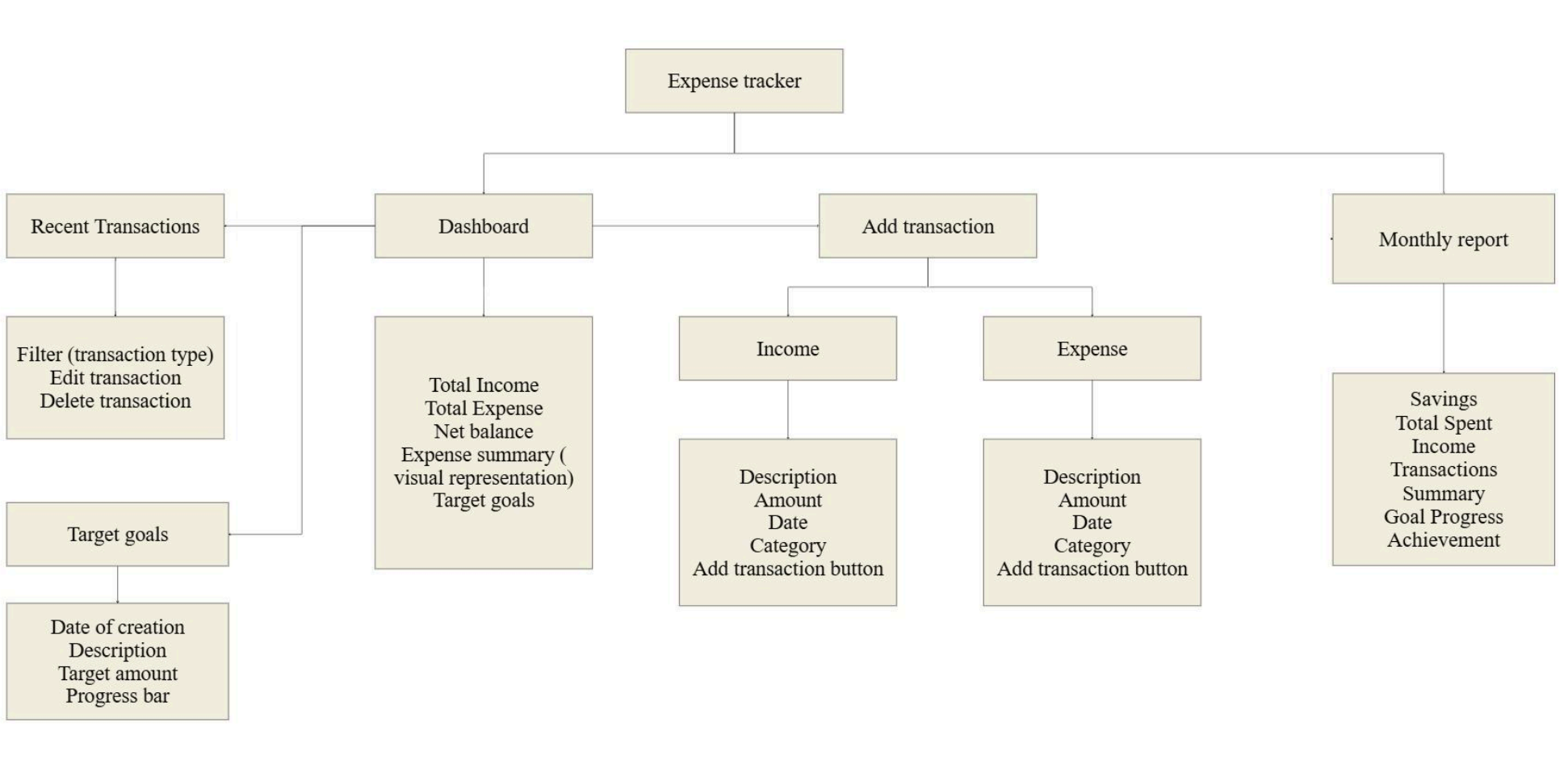
- Green indicates happy/relief feeling which represents savings and income
- Red indicates concern/awareness which represents overspending and expenses
- Transactions List: Icon indicators for expense/income with amount color coding
- Goal tracker- set up goals and monitor progress
- Monthly expense log represents monthly report of expenses with data visualization
- Pie Chart & Histogram: Quick breakdown of expense categories
- Consistent Padding & White Space: Enhances readability

Information Architecture

- Version 1

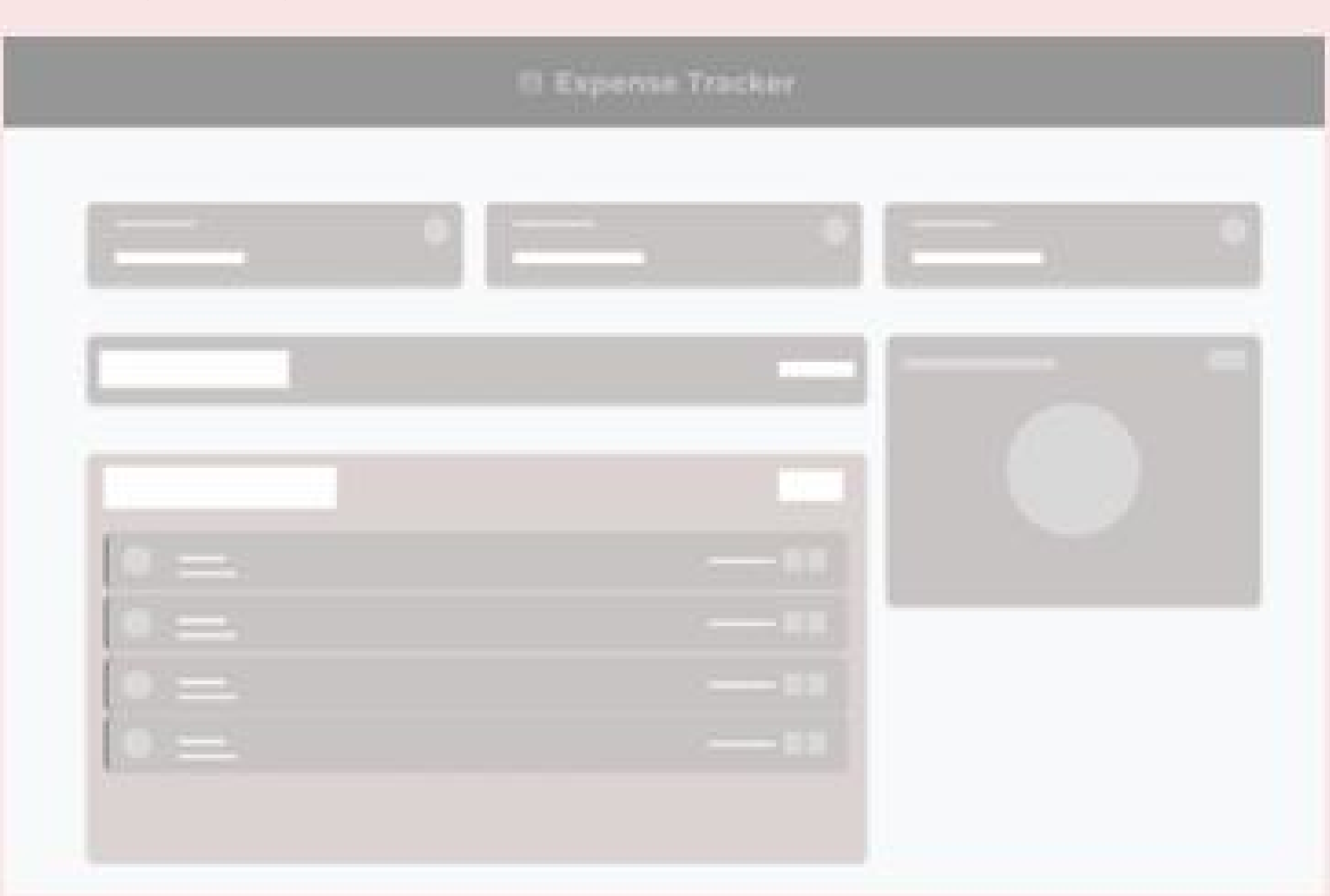

Expense tracker
Recent Transactions
Dashboard
Add transaction
Filter (transaction type)
Edit transaction
Delete transaction
Total Income
Total Expense
Net balance
Recent transactions
Expense summary (visual representation)
Income
Expense
Description
Amount
Date
Category
Add transaction button
Description
Amount
Date
Category
Add transaction button

- After mapping the initial IA, I realized users had no way to review past spending or stay motivated toward financial goals. I added Monthly Report and Target Goals as dedicated screens in v2.


Expense tracker
Recent Transactions
Dashboard
Add transaction
Monthly report
Filter (transaction type)
Edit transaction
Delete transaction
Target goals
Date of creation
Description
Target amount
Progress bar
Total Income
Total Expense
Net balance
Expense summary (visual representation)
Target goals
Income
Expense
Description
Amount
Date
Category
Add transaction button
Description
Amount
Date
Category
Add transaction button
Savings
Total Spent
Income
Transactions
Summary
Goal Progress
Achievement

Wireframing

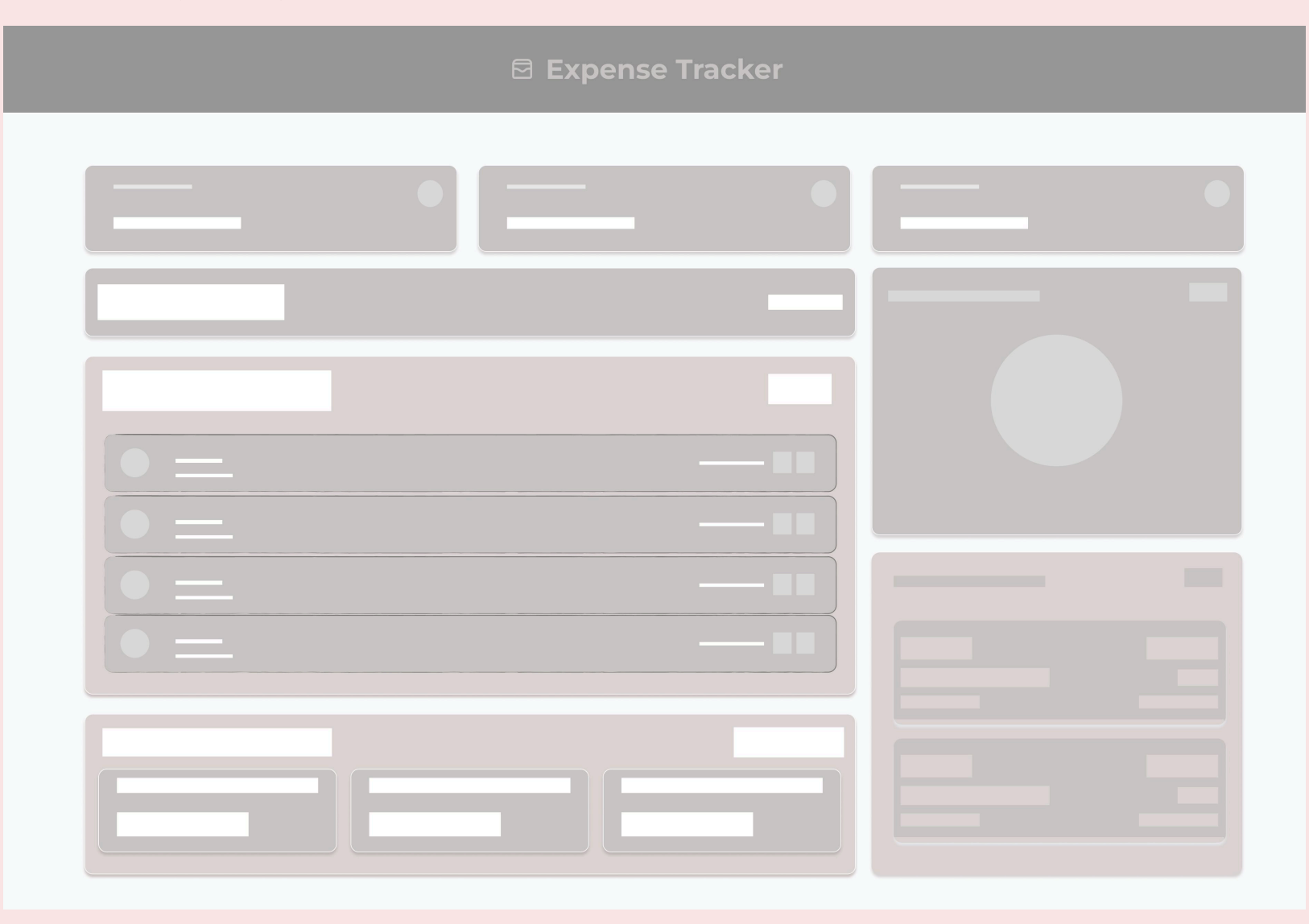
Version 1(before)


Expense Tracker

- Version 2 is advanced with motivation for users to save money and keep goal-oriented.
- Added Target Goal feature to setup goals and track them.
- Added monthly report to display monthly expenses

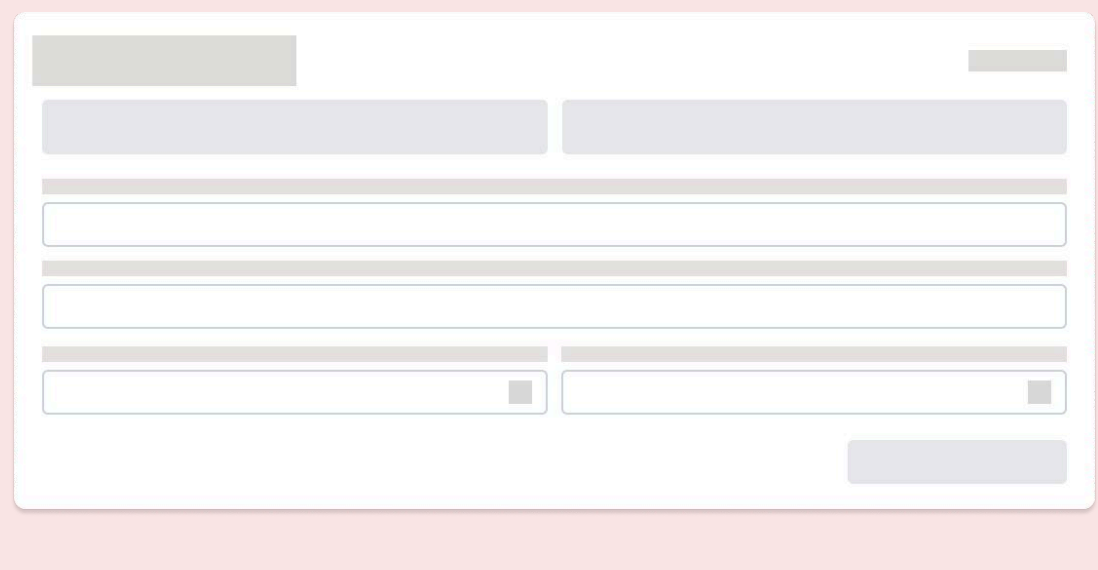
- Version 1 is simple with basic features like total expense, income and remaining balance.
- Add transaction form
- Summary with pie and bar charts
- Recent transactions with CRUD operations

Version 2(after)

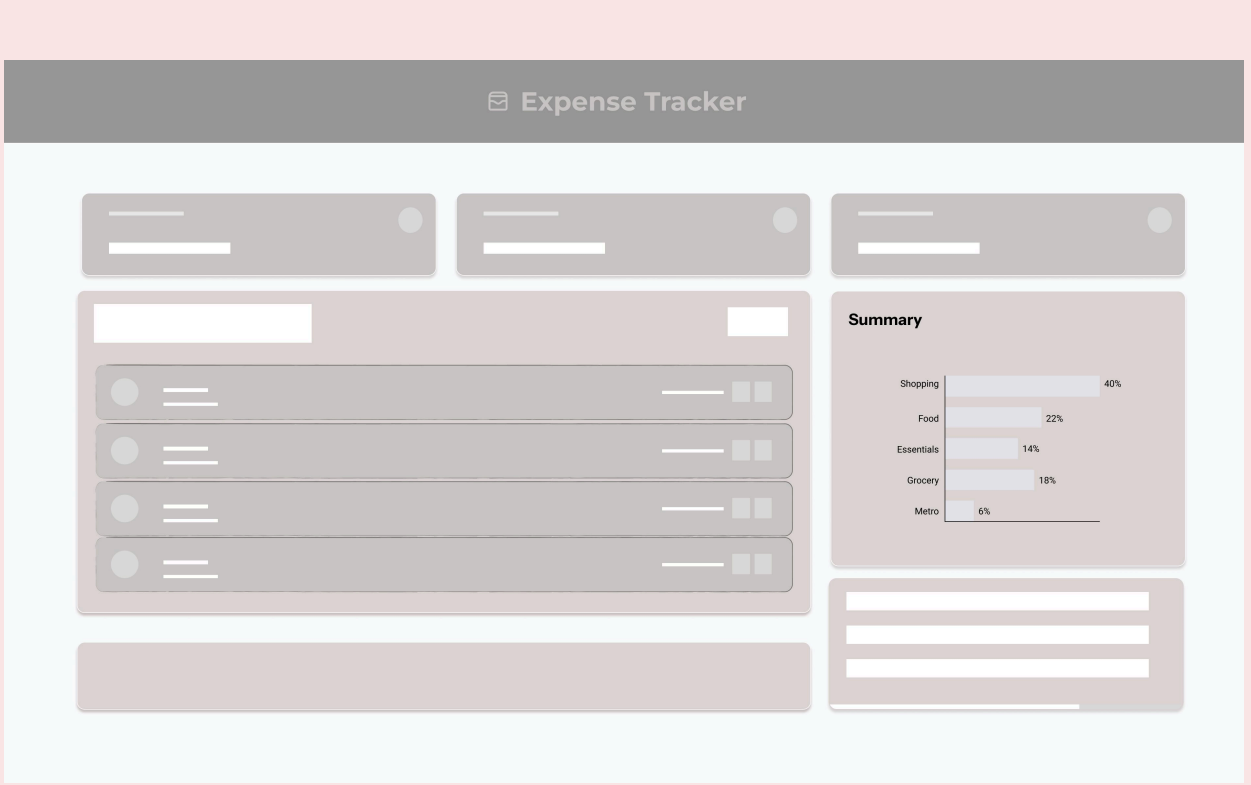

Expense Tracker

Add transactions

Add income or expense along with price, date and category.



Filter

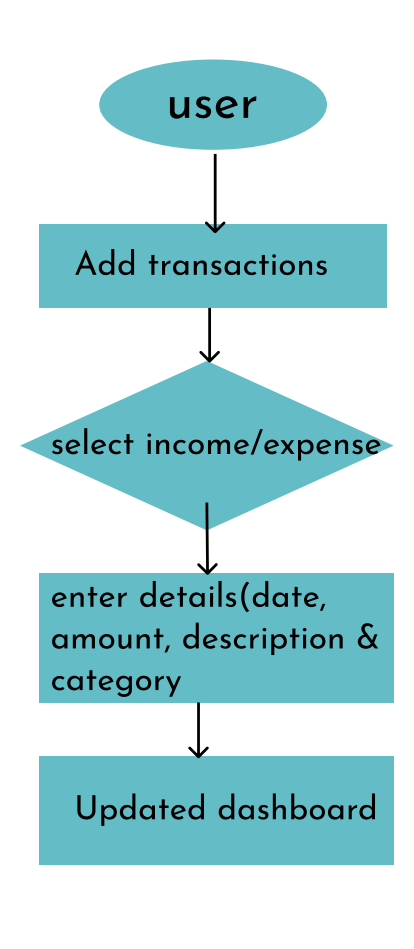

Expense Tracker
Summary

Monthly report

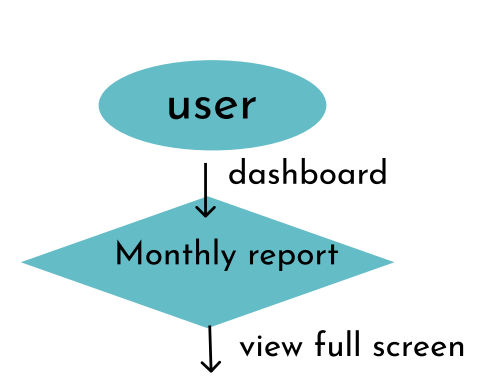
Monthly Report Screen displays total spent, savings, income along with monthly transactions with category displayed.
Shows summary using bar graph.
It shows goal progress with target amount and savings amount with a progress bar. A quote box showing achievement

User Flow

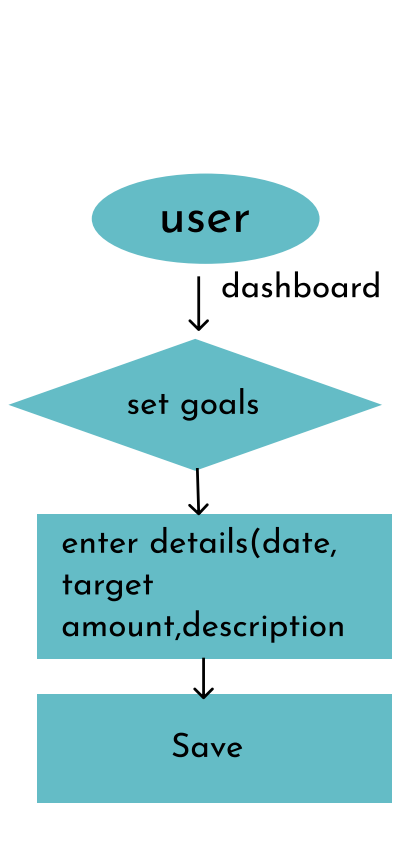
Step 1: Add a transaction


user
Add transactions
select income/expense
enter details(date, amount, description & category
Updated dashboard

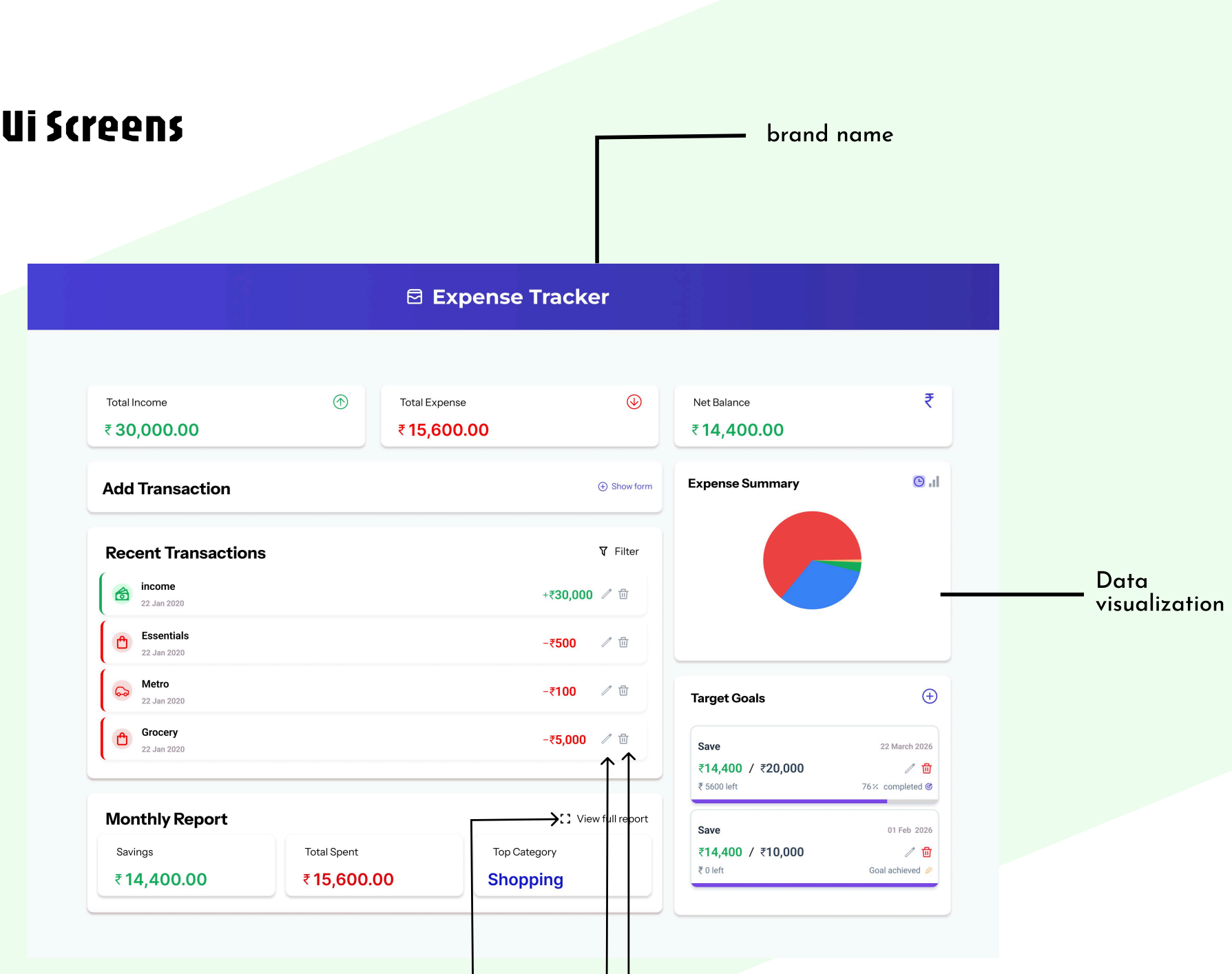
Step 2: View Monthly r


user
dashboard
Monthly report
view full screen
Summary(bar chart)
Transactions
Goal progress

Step 3: Add target goa


user
dashboard
set goals
enter details(date, target amount,description
Save

Ui Screens


brand name
Data visualization
Edit
Delete

Expense Tracker

Total Income ₹30,000.00
Total Expense ₹15,600.00
Net Balance ₹14,400.00

Add Transaction
Show form

Expense Summary

Recent Transactions
Filter

Income 22 Jan 2020	+₹30,000
Essentials 22 Jan 2020	-₹500
Metro 22 Jan 2020	-₹100
Grocery 22 Jan 2020	-₹5,000

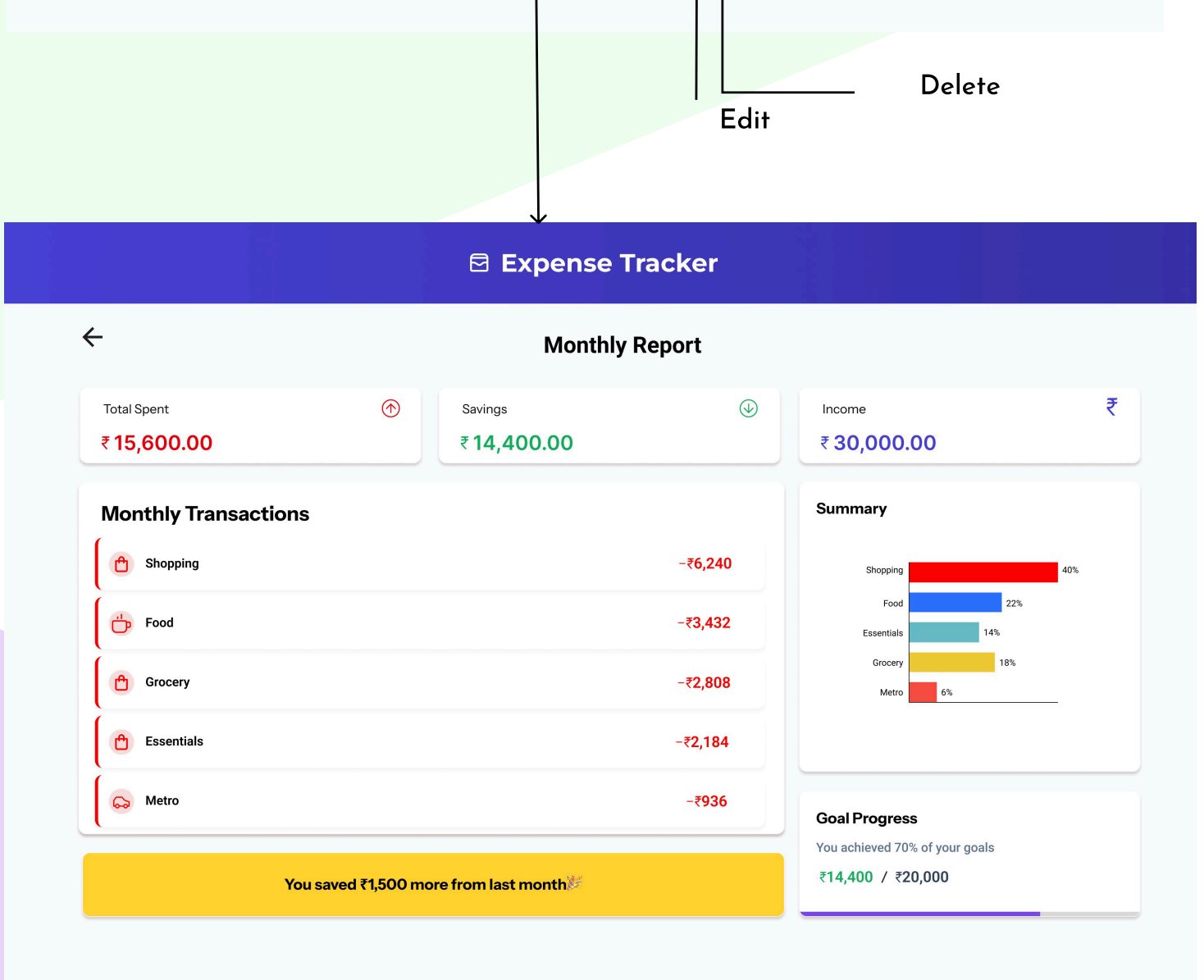
Target Goals

Save 22 March 2026
₹14,400 / ₹20,000
₹5600 left 76% completed

Save 01 Feb 2026
₹14,400 / ₹10,000
₹0 left Goal achieved

Monthly Report
View full report

Savings ₹14,400.00
Total Spent ₹15,600.00
Top Category Shopping


Shopping 40%
Food 22%
Essentials 14%
Grocery 18%
Metro 6%

Expense Tracker

Monthly Report

Total Spent ₹15,600.00
Savings ₹14,400.00
Income ₹30,000.00

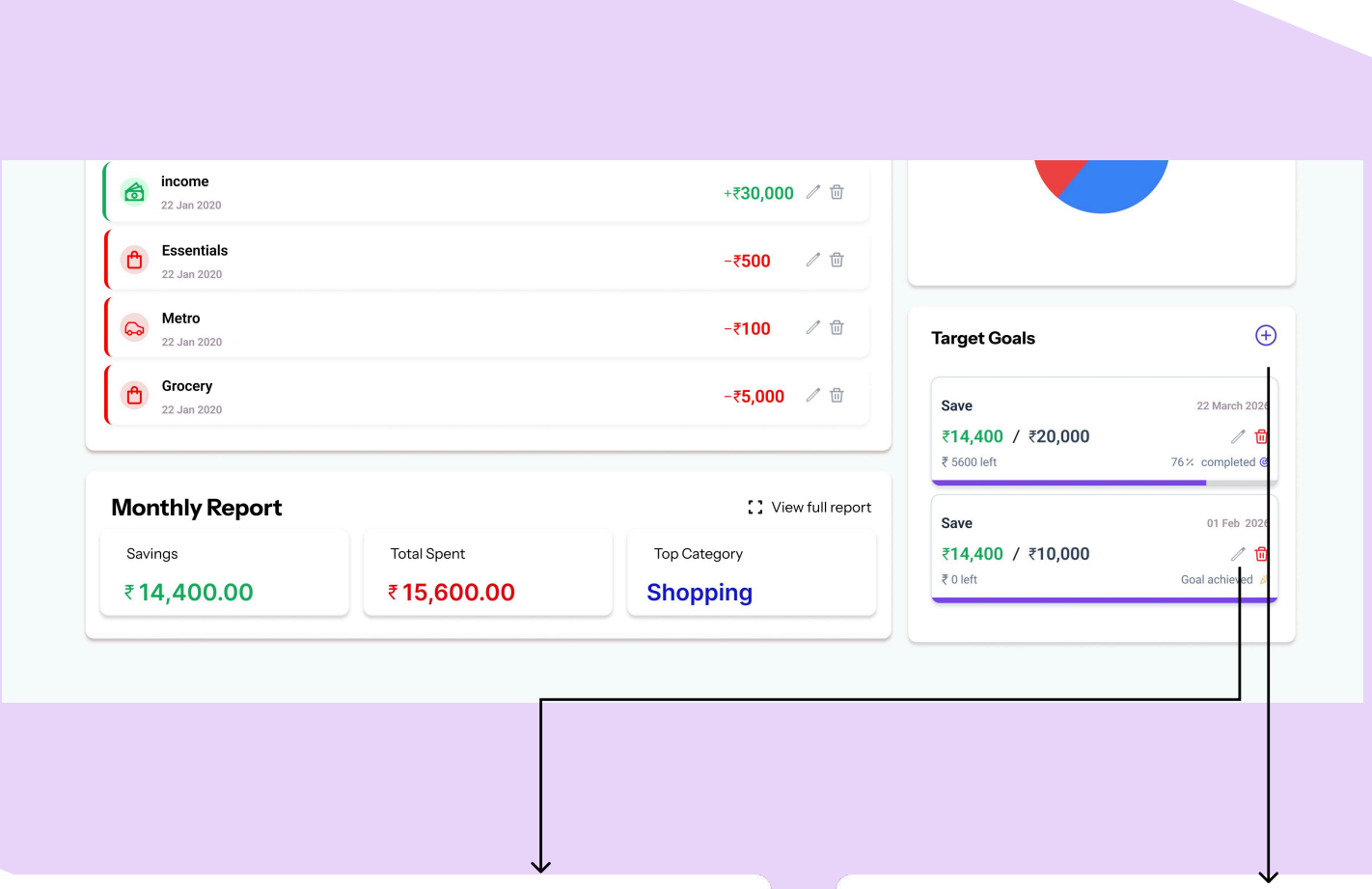
Monthly Transactions

Shopping	-₹6,240
Food	-₹3,432
Grocery	-₹2,808
Essentials	-₹2,184
Metro	-₹936

You saved ₹1,500 more from last month!

Summary

Goal Progress
You achieved 70% of your goals
₹14,400 / ₹20,000



Income 22 Jan 2020	+₹30,000
Essentials 22 Jan 2020	-₹500
Metro 22 Jan 2020	-₹100
Grocery 22 Jan 2020	-₹5,000

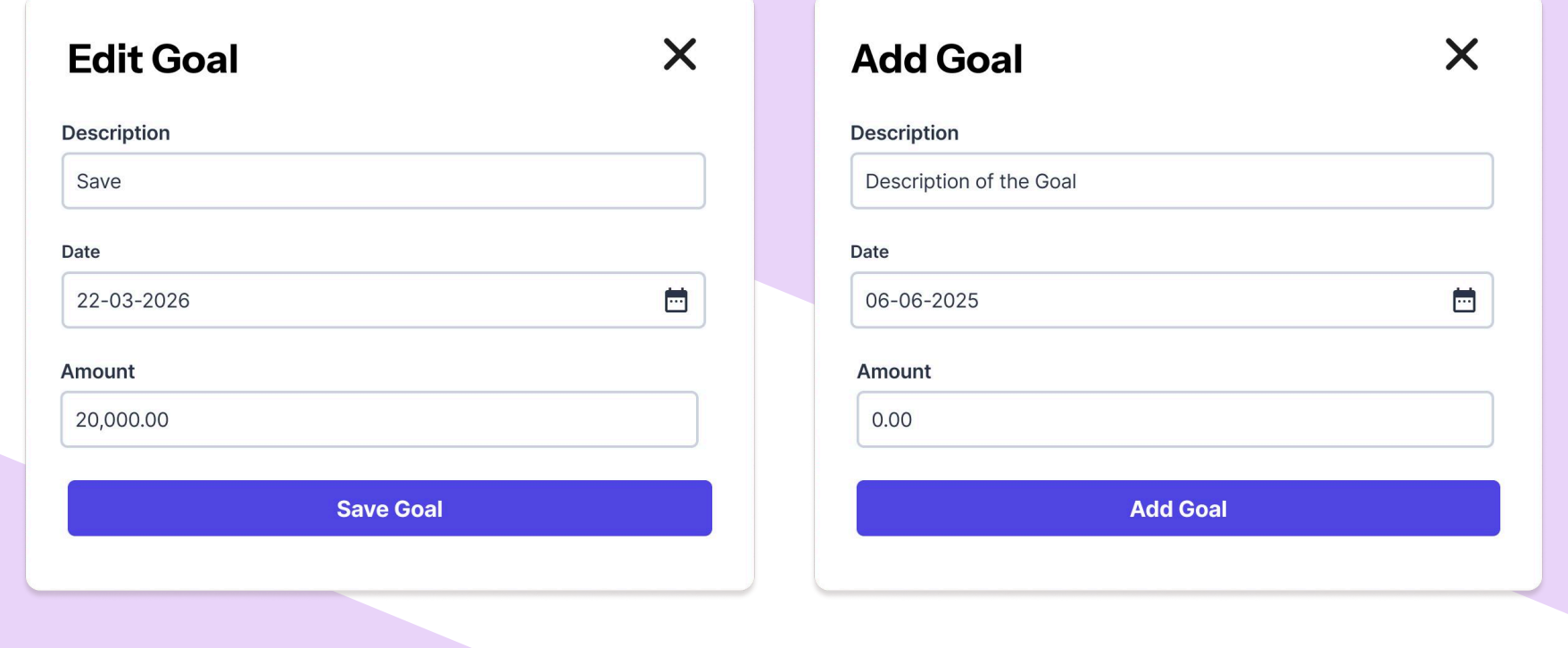
Monthly Report
View full report

Savings ₹14,400.00
Total Spent ₹15,600.00
Top Category Shopping

Target Goals

Save
₹14,400 / ₹20,000

Save
₹14,400 / ₹10,000



Edit Goal

Description: Save

Date: 22-03-2026

Amount: 20,000.00

Save Goal

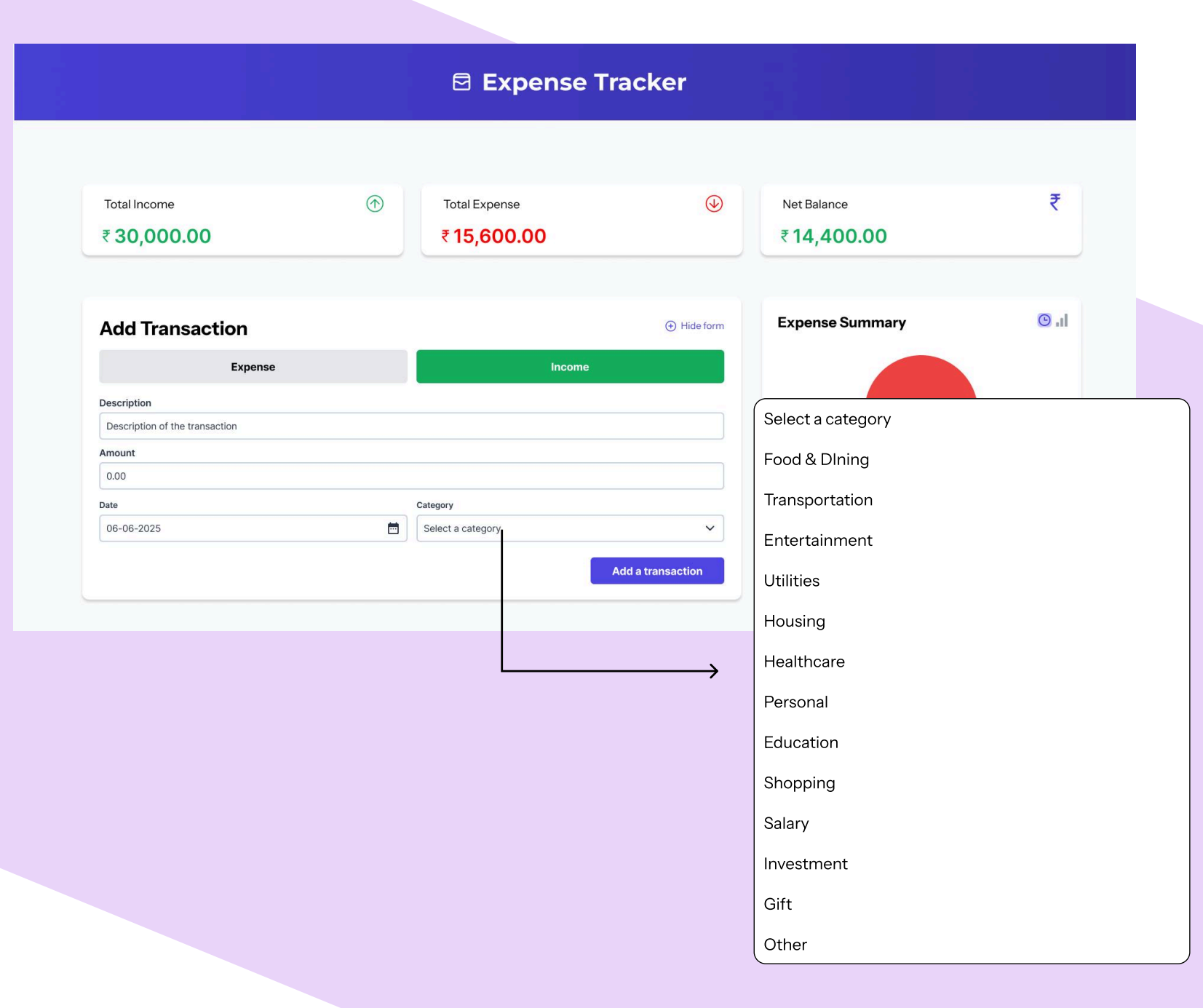
Add Goal

Description: Description of the Goal

Date: 06-06-2025

Amount: 0.00

Add Goal


Expense
Income
Add a transaction

Expense Tracker

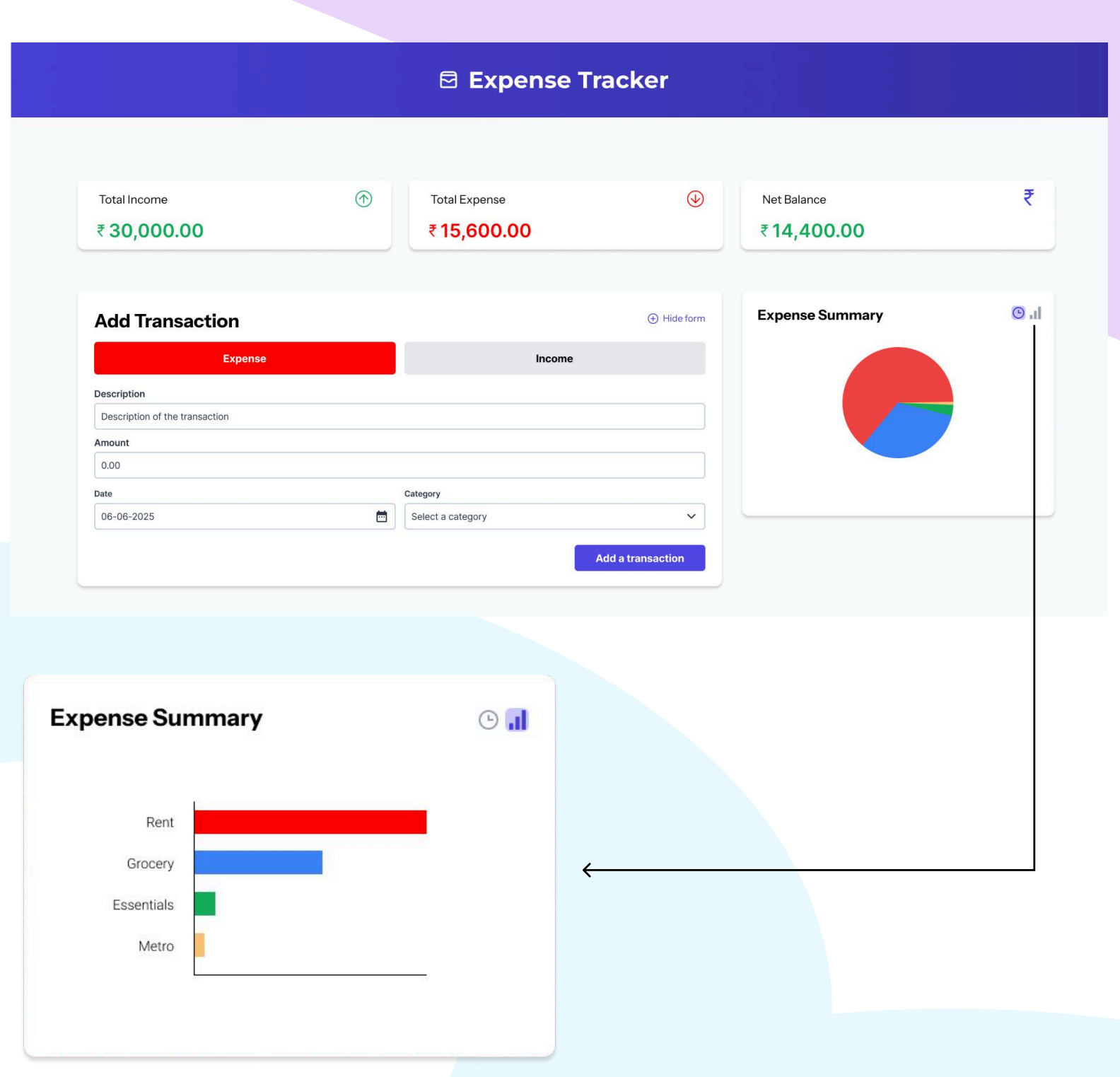
Total Income ₹30,000.00
Total Expense ₹15,600.00
Net Balance ₹14,400.00

Add Transaction
Hide form

Description: Description of the transaction
Amount: 0.00
Date: 06-06-2025
Category: Select a category

Expense Summary

- Select a category
- Food & Dining
- Transportation
- Entertainment
- Utilities
- Housing
- Healthcare
- Personal
- Education
- Shopping
- Salary
- Investment
- Gift
- Other


Expense
Income
Add a transaction
Rent
Grocery
Essentials
Metro

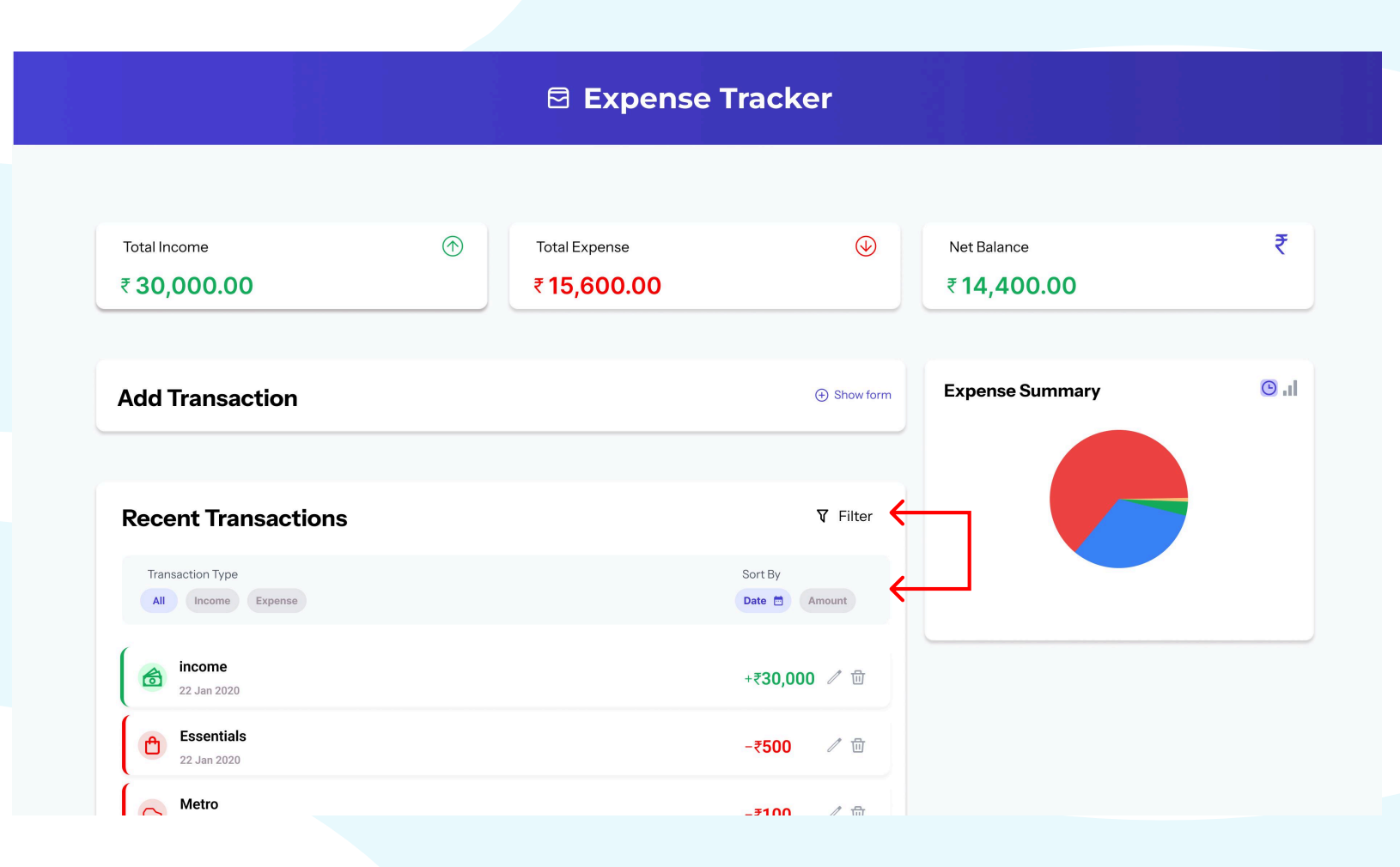
Expense Tracker

Total Income ₹30,000.00
Total Expense ₹15,600.00
Net Balance ₹14,400.00

Add Transaction
Hide form

Description: Description of the transaction
Amount: 0.00
Date: 06-06-2025
Category: Select a category

Expense Summary


Transaction Type
All
Income
Expense
Sort By
Date
Amount

Expense Tracker

Total Income ₹30,000.00
Total Expense ₹15,600.00
Net Balance ₹14,400.00

Add Transaction
Show form

Expense Summary

Recent Transactions
Filter

Income 22 Jan 2020	+₹30,000
Essentials 22 Jan 2020	-₹500
Metro	

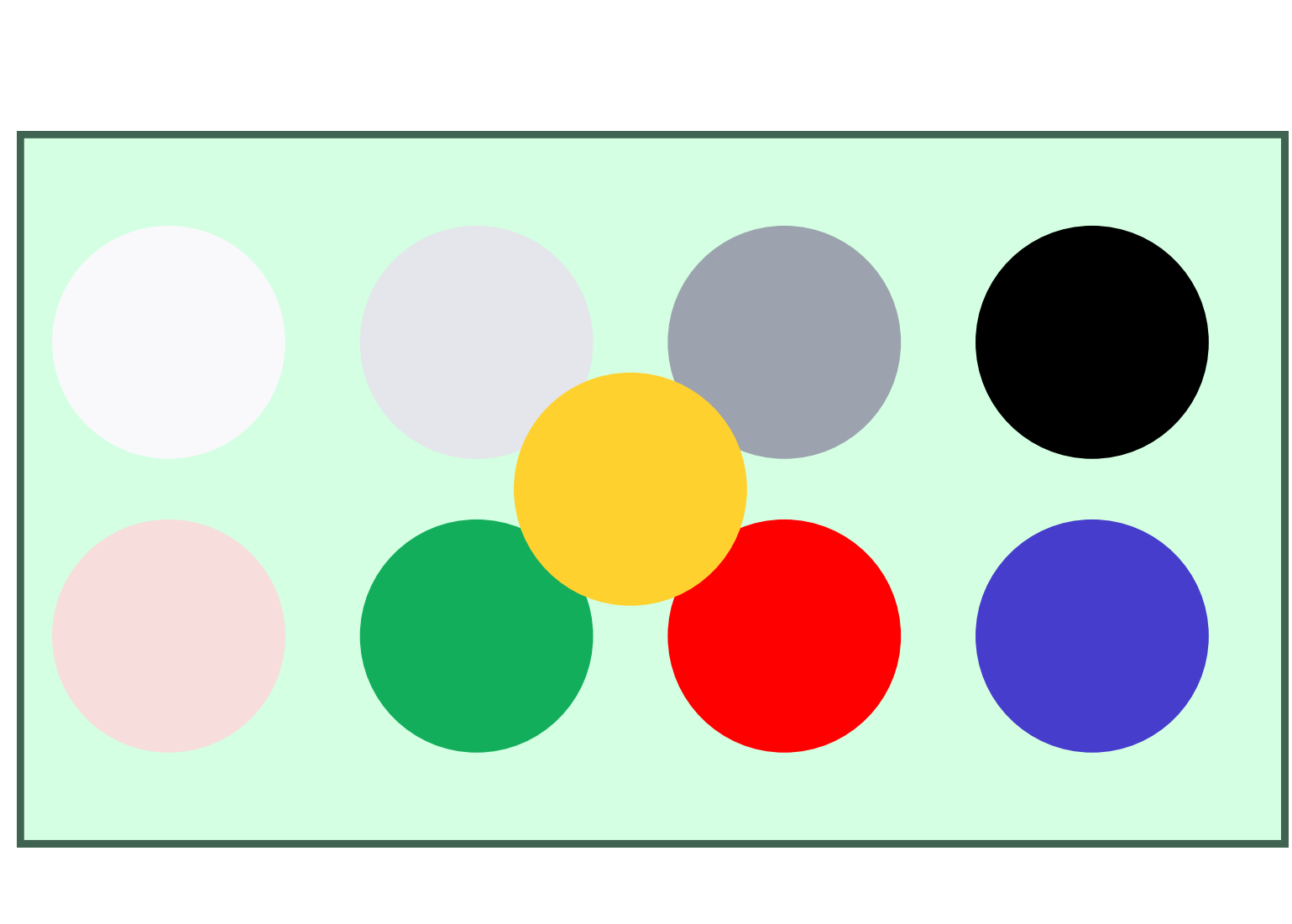
Typography

- Roboto Semi Bold
- **Instrument Sans Bold**
- Instrument Sans Regular

Tools Used

- Figma - Wireframing & UI Design
- Miro

Color Palette



Learnings

- The hardest decision was scrapping my initial layout mid-way and starting over. It felt risky, but experimenting with the structure helped me discover that the dashboard was overloaded - rebuilding the structure to accommodate Target Goals and Monthly Report forced me to rethink spacing and alignment across every screen.
- If I built this again, I would introduce a sidebar navigation to better organize the growing feature set, and push further on motivation - things like spending challenges, streaks, or milestone celebrations. V2 added Goals, but there's a whole layer of behavioral nudges that could make the app genuinely habit-forming.
- I was surprised by how complex the Monthly Report screen turned out to be. It seemed straightforward at first, but deciding what data to surface, how to prioritize it, and how to lay it out without overwhelming the user required the most deliberate thinking of the whole project.